

# A DIFFICULT SUMMER

SENTIMENT IMPROVED A NOTCH FROM Q1 BUT IS DOWN 11% YOY. THE SURVEY REVEALS FAULT LINES WITH GST CUTS FAILING TO LIFT THE MOOD MUCH. WILL FESTIVE DEMAND BRIGHTEN THE OUTLOOK IN Q3?

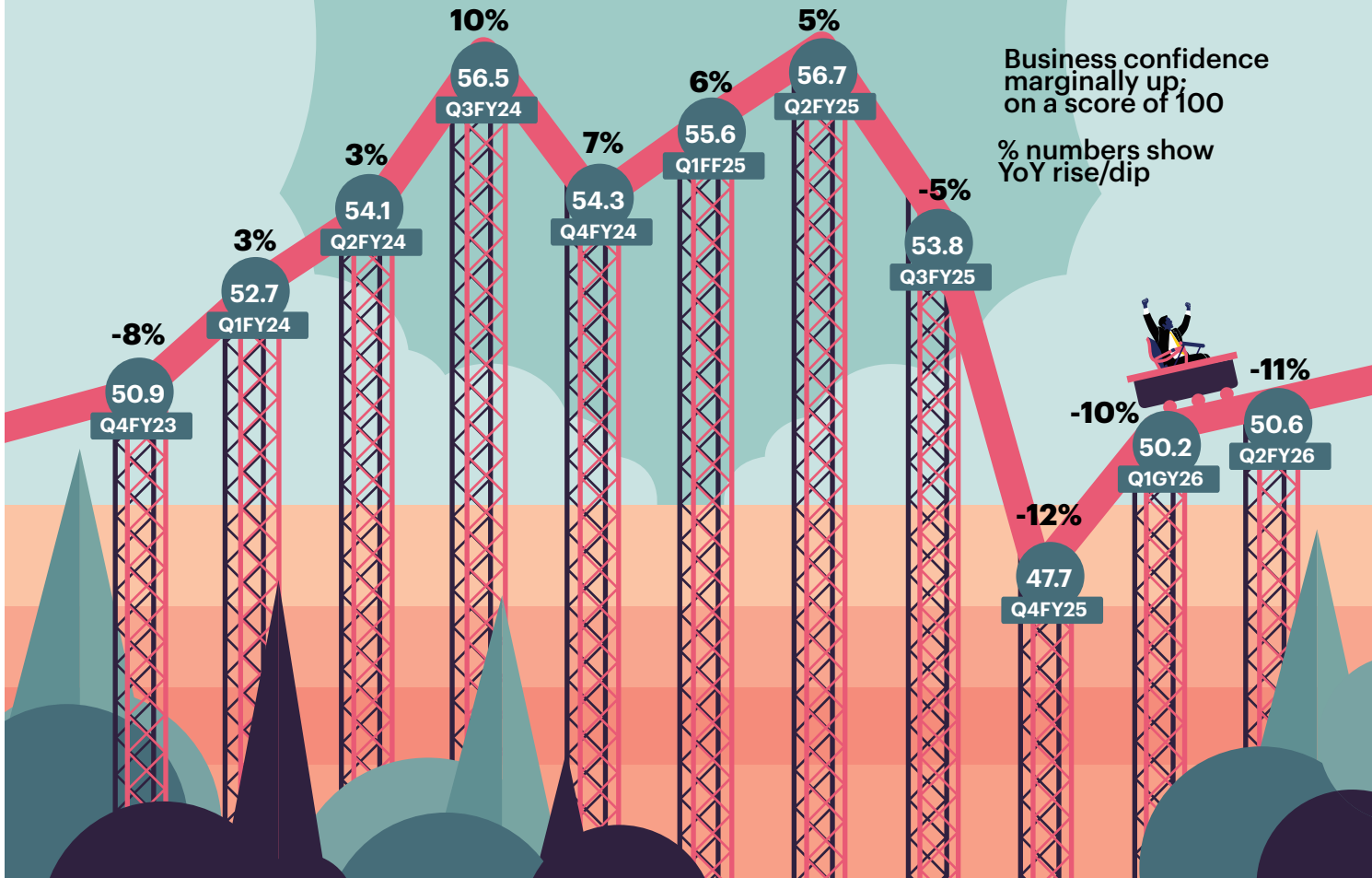


ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**



66% respondents say GST cuts have not increased sales. Festive season could boost sentiment in Q3



On ease of doing business, 69% say they have not seen an improvement or things have worsened



Only 23% respondents are planning higher capital investments this fiscal; 63% said a definitive no